PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mercedes-Benz G 500 4×4²

2015–2018 · W463 · Portal axles

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Make sure it's a real one**
  Shops build 4×4² lookalikes from ordinary Gs — some, like Banyan Motors' portal-axle G 500, are serious builds, but they aren't factory trucks. Confirm the VIN, window sticker and data card.
- [ ] **Price the tires before the truck**
  Factory fitment is 325/55R22 on 9.5×22 wheels — big, heavy and not cheap. Check tread depth and date codes, and whether the spare matches.
- [ ] **Test the adjustable dampers**
  Switch between Comfort and Sport on the drive. You should feel the difference immediately; a fault light or no change means a damper or control problem.
- [ ] **Test all three lockers**
  Engage centre, rear and front on a loose surface and watch the indicators. Trucks that never left pavement often have lazy lockers.
- [ ] **Inspect the carbon flares and roof**
  The detachable carbon-fibre arch extensions and roof-mounted lights live high and wide — look for cracks, chips and scratches (one BaT example noted roof scratches).
- [ ] **Ask for the service file**
  Spark plugs, ignition coils, transmission fluid and filter, brake fluid — the BaT example's history shows the kind of records to expect. Ask specifically about portal-hub and axle oil changes.
- [ ] **Measure your garage**
  It's 88 inches tall and 86.2 inches wide with mirrors. Parking structures and automatic car washes are now hostile territory.
- [ ] **Rust where nobody cleans**
  It's still a W463: check the tailgate lower edge, door bottoms, sills, rear frame tubes and strut mounts.

YEARS TO KNOW

2022–2023	RECALL	Rear differential housing recalls (22V937, 23V851) on the new G 63 4×4²; check the VIN

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Brake booster vacuum hose**
  2017 · NHTSA 17V817
- [ ] **Rear axle differential housing (G 63 4×4², second generation)**
  2022 · NHTSA 22V937

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **VIN characters 4–8**
  Bring a Trailer's US 4×4²s decode in NHTSA's vPIC as WDCYC5FF… (2017) and WDCYC5FH… (2018; vPIC series 'G550 4×4'). A regular 2016–2018 G 550 reads WDCYC3KF… / WDCYC3KH….

- [ ] **Rear axle differential housing (G 63 4×4², second generation)**
  2022–2023 · NHTSA 23V851

- [ ] **Model year**
  The 10th character is H for 2017 and J for 2018. US trucks were sold as 2017 models, and some were titled as 2018s.

- [ ] **Track and tires**
  Factory trucks run 325/55R22 tires on 9.5×22 wheels, and the front track is about 9 in wider (rear about 10 in) than a standard G, with carbon-fibre arch extensions to cover it.

- [ ] **Suspension**
  Factory trucks have KW-developed dual-spring struts with adjustable damping at each corner, and a Comfort/Sport damper switch inside. Portal hubs without that suspension point to a conversion.

- [ ] **Window sticker and data card**
  Ask for the Monroney label and the Mercedes data card. The US MSRP was $225,000 before options.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/g-class/4×4-squared/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks